

Derek Wang

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TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: C++, Java, Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, SQL

Frameworks: React, Next.js, Node.js, Express, FastAPI

Libraries/Tools: PyTorch, OpenCV, SQLite, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Docker, Git

Robotics: ROS2, Foxglove, Fusion 360

Certifications: Docker Foundations Professional

EXPERIENCE

Autonomous Self Driving Software Engineer

Sept 2025 – Present

WATonomous

Waterloo, ON, Canada

- Implemented ROS2 navigation stack (costmaps, A* planning, Pure Pursuit) enabling autonomous rover path following in dynamic environments.
- Led YOLO11s model retraining, improving detection mAP from 30% to 80% across 3,448 labeled images via hyperparameter tuning and augmentation redesign
- Optimized YOLO11s inference to 30 FPS on rover hardware via ONNX export and onnxslim optimization.

Autonomy Developer

Aug 2025 – Feb 2026

Waterloo Aerial Robotics Group

Waterloo, ON, Canada

- Built Python hardware-in-the-loop UAV simulation using MAVLink for the 2026 UAS Student Competition.
- Eliminated GPS teleportation bugs and achieved smooth trajectory interpolation via periodic position updates

Robotics Software Programmer – VEX Robotics Competition

Sept 2024 – June 2025

Checkmate Robotics Club

Markham, Ontario

- Reduced autonomous robot positioning error by 40% by implementing odometry and PID trajectory control.
- Qualified for 2025 VEX World Championships (top 10% globally) and placed 5th/80 at Provincials.

PROJECTS

Silhouette | *Node.js, Next.js, Express, MongoDB, Gemini, Overshoot.ai SDK*

- Built a real-time AI fashion advisor with live camera input at NexHacks, earning a VC referral to continue development for Merian Brothers
- Built MERN full-stack application to deliver real-time outfit analysis and product recommendations
- Integrated Gemini vision APIs for live video outfit analysis returning recommendations in under 2 seconds

Hierarchical Reasoning Retrieval | *Node.js, Express, SQLite, Gemini*

- Built hierarchical LLM document retrieval system traversing heading trees instead of flat vector similarity
- Implemented beam search traversal over document heading trees for structured document search
- Built markdown ingestion pipeline generating document trees and hybrid retrieval using SQLite FTS5 + LLM branch selection

Autonomous Vehicle Control System | *C++, ROS2, Docker, CMake, Foxglove*

- Built a C++ LiDAR perception pipeline generating real-time occupancy costmaps at 0.1m resolution in Foxglove
- Developed ROS2 autonomous navigation stack with Docker, validating obstacle avoidance across 50+ simulations.
- Simulated robot navigation and visualized perception outputs in Foxglove for debugging and testing

Coffee Chat Scheduler | *React, Python, FastAPI, PostgreSQL, Google Calendar API*

- Built full stack booking app integrating Google Calendar OAuth for real-time scheduling (20+ coffee chats)
- Stored booking data in PostgreSQL via SQLAlchemy, with automated event creation and availability checking

EDUCATION

University of Waterloo

Expected Apr 2030

Bachelor of Applied Science in Computer Engineering (Co-op)

GPA: 3.7

- Relevant Coursework:** Linear Algebra, Fundamentals of Programming